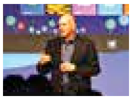

300 million Windows 10

Windows 10 is installed on over 400 million devices used by over 300 million users for more than three hours daily. **http://dgit.in/300Win10**

Alpine Linux 3.6 released

Good news for all linux users, Alpine Linux 3.6.0 has finally been released to the public. Learn more about it here: **http://dgit.in/Alpine36**

PERFORMANCE

Samsung Galaxy S8

Of the three devices we're comparing, the Galaxy S8 is the only one running a 2017 chipset. We're yet to test the Snapdragon 835, but the Exynos 8895 is every bit its equal, at least on paper. It's a 10nm chipset, supports Gigabit LTE speeds and has oodles of power, as a flagship chipset should.

It blows most of our benchmark scores away, barring MobileXPRT, where scores are slightly lower, but still in the flagship range. On gaming, the Galaxy S8 achieved 60 fps frame rates wherever possible, while heat levels are quite well managed too. Samsung uses its Mongoose cores to good effect, which kick in every time there are UI transitions. This ensures that regular usage remains smooth and you don't see UI lags that have been very common amongst past Samsung smartphones.

The Galaxy S8 switches between mobile data and WiFi really fast, enough to rival the iPhone.

LG G6

The Snapdragon 835 is an evolutionary update over the Snapdragon 821, which is why LG using an older SoC doesn't really matter as much. You're still getting top-of-the-line specifications, if not absolutely high end. So, the LG G6 can hardly be called a slow smartphone, although our experience with it was somewhat underwhelming. Performance testing using benchmarks show that the LG G6 is only about 10% faster than the G5, which is pretty much what you expect (between the 820 and 821). While the LG G6's performance is not under question due to the SoC, we saw quite some lag and a few stutters on the device, even during regular UI transitions.

This continues in gaming performance, where the LG G6 clocked a maximum of 55 fps. This is actually beyond playable levels, but in strict comparative terms, it makes the G6 underpowered as compared to the Samsung Galaxy S8.

Sony Xperia XZs

As mentioned above, the Snapdragon 820 and 821 differ by only about 10% in terms of raw power. So, it's not surprising that the Xperia XZs produces similar performance scores as the LG G6. You see better performance on graphics tests like GFXBench and 3D Mark, thanks to a lower resolution display, but the two phones are evenly matched overall.

The Xperia XZs gaming performance was beyond question overall, although it failed to clock up to stable 60fps frame rates like the Galaxy S8. Nevertheless, 56 fps frame rates put it in the flagship level, which is not surprising at all.

It's really difficult to spot, but the Sony Xperia XZ can sometimes take a split second longer to open apps, than we'd expect. The phone is at par with any flagship you can think of, but we saw black loading screens a tad too often than we would have liked.

BATTERY

Samsung Galaxy S8

The Samsung Galaxy S8 is middling in this respect, lasting almost 9 hours on the PC Mark test. In general, the phone powered through to about 12 hours on toned down usage, while heavier days needed a charge after just over 10 hours. It's worth noting that the larger, Galaxy S8 Plus lasts over 11 hours on the PC Mark test.

LG G6

It seems the largest battery wins in this comparison. The LG G6 has a 3300 mAh battery against the Galaxy S8's 3000 mAh and Xperia XZ's 2900 mAh units. PC Mark's test takes just over 11 hours to bring battery percentage down from 80% to 20%. On regular usage, we got the best battery life out of the LG G6, which is about two hours more than the Galaxy S8.

Sony Xperia XZs

Much like the camera department, Sony once again attains flagship performance, but comes in last on this test. It lasts 7 hours and 11 minutes on the PC Mark test and 10-11 hours over regular usage. We expected the lower resolution display to allow higher battery life, so resulting scores on the Xperia XZs are somewhat disappointing.